# System.

CAP HEIGHT TO BASELINE

OVERUSED GROTESK 600 · −3% TRACKING

BRAND & PRODUCT MANUAL

Type, grid, color and components, specified once for both the brand and the product, and ready to hand to whoever builds next.

WEB · APPS · TYPE · MARKETING

SHEETS 00–18

# Contents

Every sheet is optional. Switch off what the client doesn’t bring, and the manual falls back to type and grid instead of leaving a hole.


| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 02 | Landing | WEB |
| 03 | Logo | IDENTITY |
| 04 | Color | IDENTITY |
| 05 | Display | IDENTITY |
| 06 | Text | IDENTITY |
| 07 | Mono | IDENTITY |
| 08 | Grid | LAYOUT |
| 09 | Icons | IDENTITY |
| 10 | Imagery | IDENTITY |
| 11 | Components | PRODUCT |
| 12 | Apps | PRODUCT |
| 13 | Motion | PRODUCT |
| 14 | Voice | WRITING |
| 15 | Marketing | MEDIA |
| 16 | Print | MEDIA |
| 17 | Downloads | FILES |
| 18 | Utility | WEB |
| 00 | Cover | ↑ |


## WITH / WITHOUT

SET AT SETUP

| | |
|---|---|
| Logo | WITH / WITHOUT |
| Icon set | WITH / WITHOUT |
| Imagery | WITH / WITHOUT |

## FALLBACKS

NEVER AN EMPTY SLOT

Each switch flips its sheets between the client’s assets and the template’s own fallback: a typographic wordmark for the logo, mono glyph cells for the icons, and drafting frames for the pictures.

# Landing



One column of argument: a headline that says what it is, one action, then three reasons. The grid lines keep running behind it.

SYSTEM.EXAMPLE

System.

PRODUCT PRICING DOCS

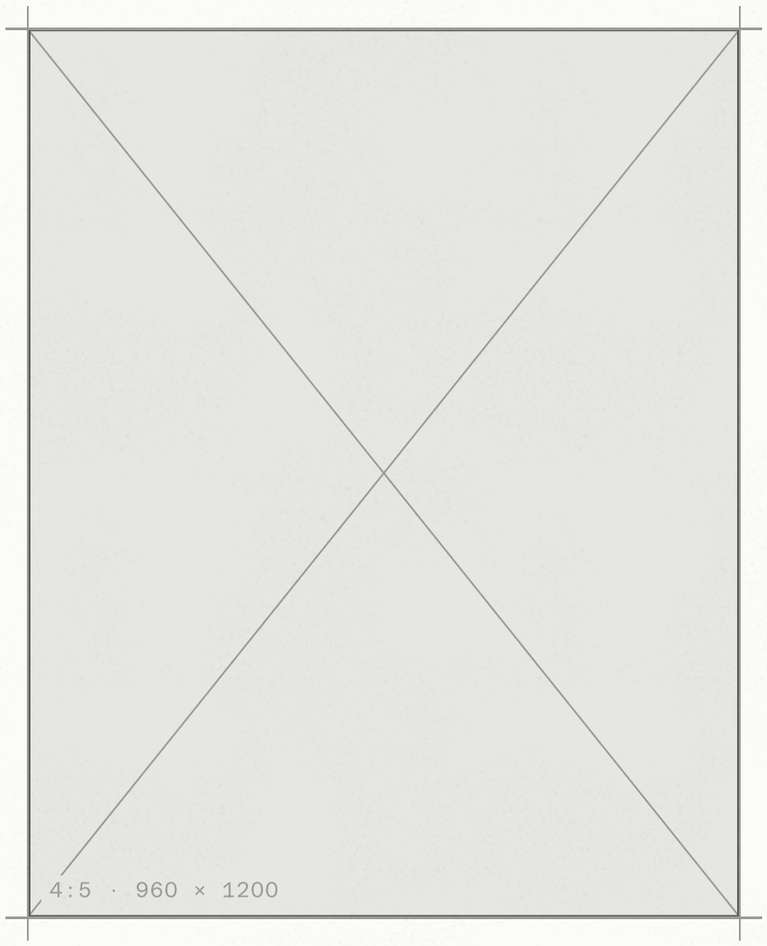
Sign in

## Build the brand once, use it everywhere

Type, grid and color set up as one system, so the website, the app and the posters come out looking related.

Get the files

Read the manual




### One source

Tokens live in one file. Change the accent there and every sheet updates.

### Works without assets

No logo or icon set yet? Type and grid carry the identity until they arrive.

### Ships as files

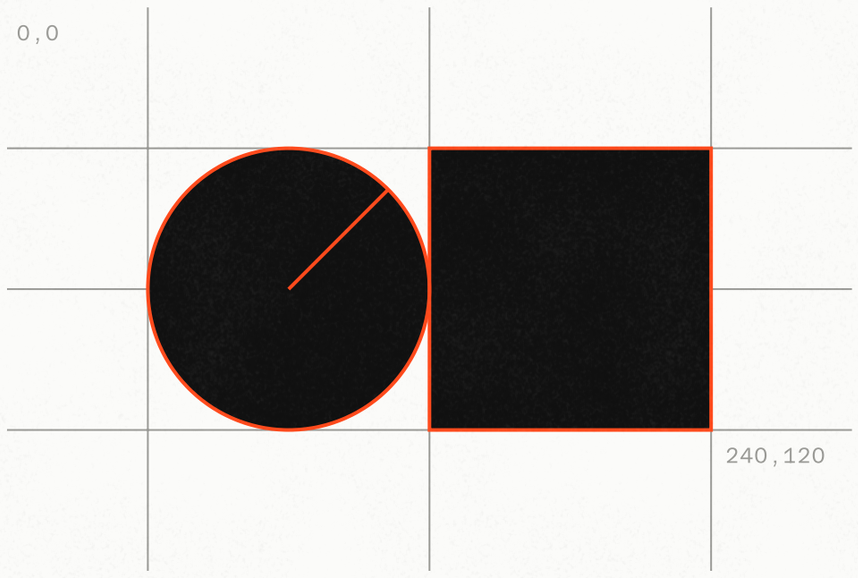
Logos, tokens and print PDFs come out of one script, ready to send.

# Logo



The mark is a circle and a square of equal height. Keep half the mark height clear around the logo, and two thirds after the name, so the open end of the word balances the mark.

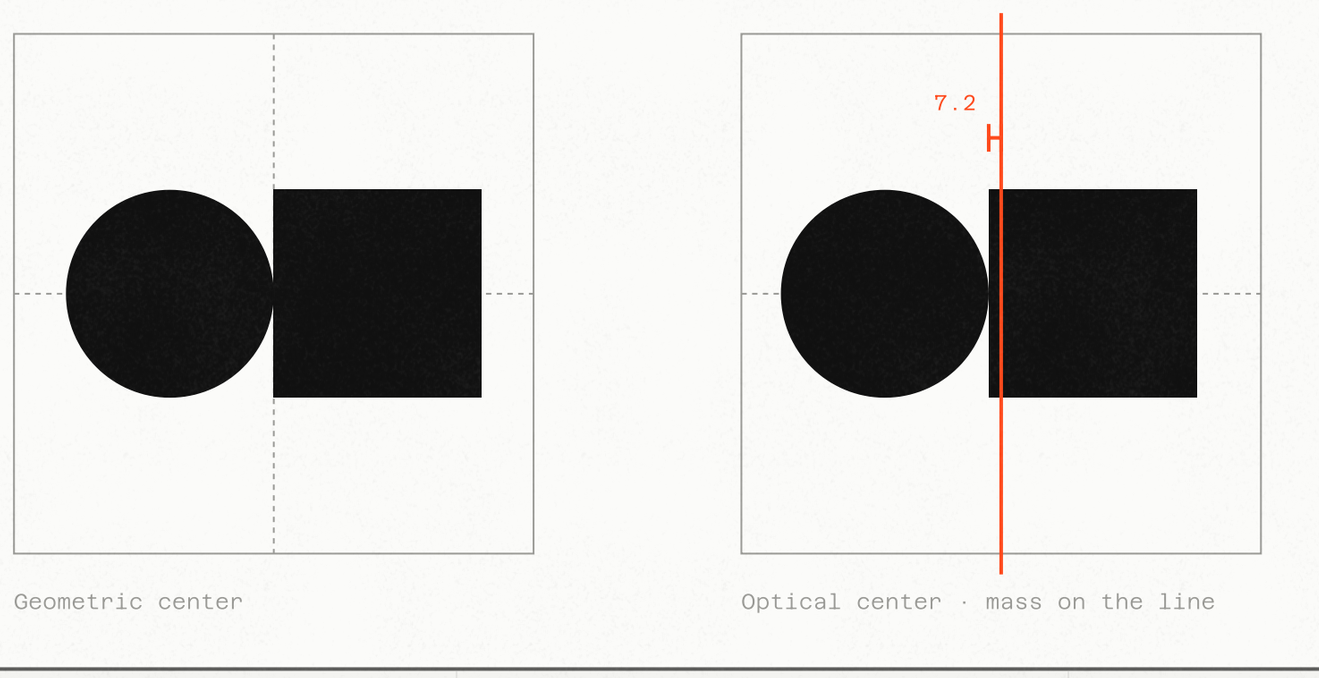
CONSTRUCTION — R = 1 UNIT




CLEAR SPACE — 1/2 AND 2/3 OF THE MARK HEIGHT




OPTICAL CENTER — SHIFT 7.2 = 3% OF THE WIDTH




WHY — MARK ALONE

### The square is heavier

It holds 14 400 units² against the circle's 11 310, so the mark's center of mass sits at 127.2 of its 240, not at 120.

### Shift it 7.2 left

Wherever the mark stands alone and centered, on the splash, app icons and avatars, move it 3% of its width to the left, so the weight lands on the center.

### Not in lockups

Next to the name the word balances it. Lockups align on their clear space instead.

LOCKUPS — MIN. 24 PX MARK

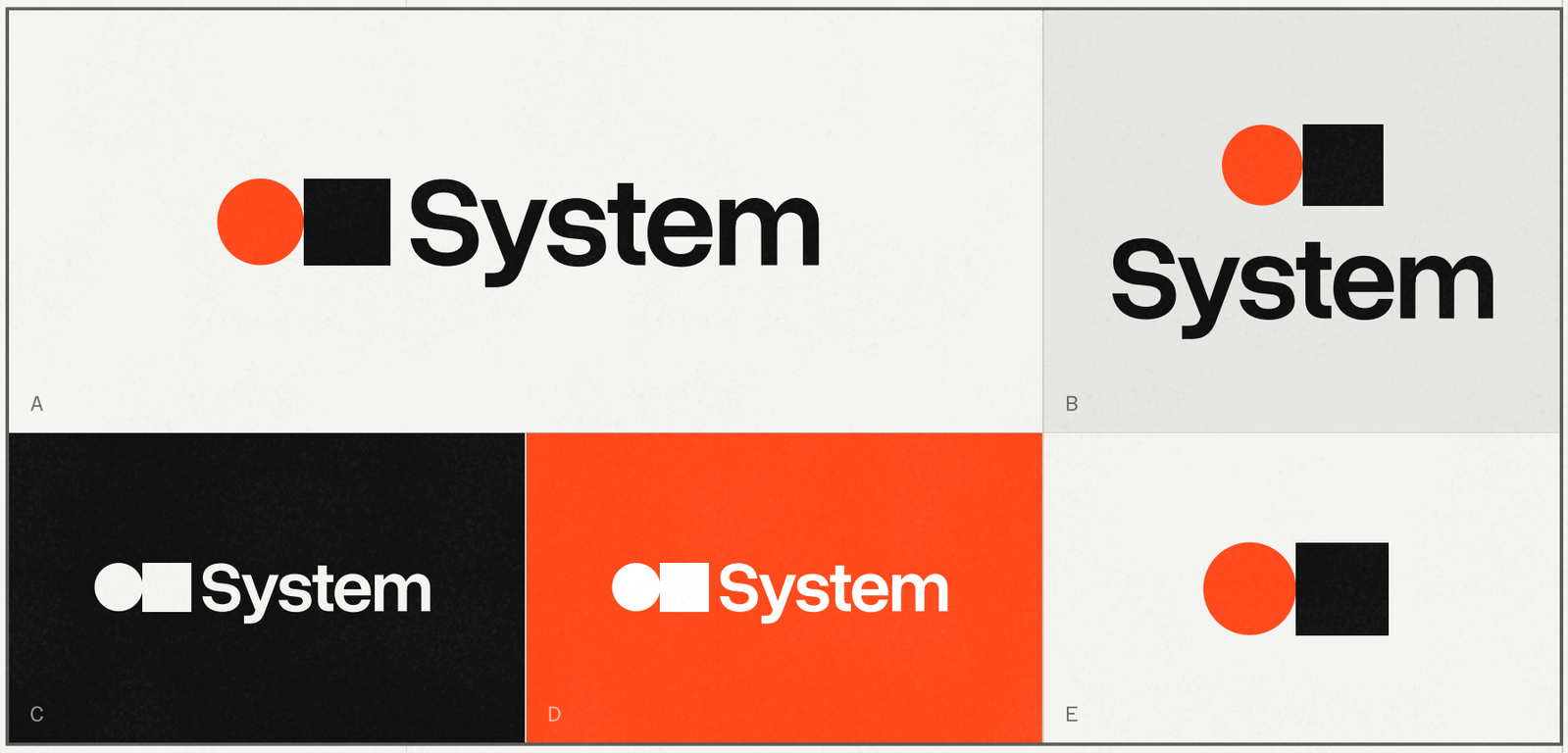
A **Primary.** Ink on paper. Use it wherever you can.

B **Stacked.** For square and narrow formats, avatars and stickers.

C **On ink.** Paper on the ink color, for dark screens and the back of cards.

D **Reversed.** White on the accent, once per spread at most.

E **Mark only.** When the name is already on screen, and below 120 px of lockup width.



# Color



Paper, ink and three grays do the work. The accent is a drop: one key word, one active state, one full stop.

### Paper

| | |
|---|---|
| HEX | #F4F4F1 |
| RGB | 244 244 241 |
| CMYK | 0 0 1 4 |

### Ink

| | |
|---|---|
| HEX | #111111 |
| RGB | 17 17 17 |
| CMYK | 0 0 0 93 |

### Gray 600

| | |
|---|---|
| HEX | #5C5C5A |
| RGB | 92 92 90 |
| CMYK | 0 0 2 64 |

### Gray 400

| | |
|---|---|
| HEX | #9A9A96 |
| RGB | 154 154 150 |
| CMYK | 0 0 3 40 |

### Gray 100

| | |
|---|---|
| HEX | #E6E6E2 |
| RGB | 230 230 226 |
| CMYK | 0 0 2 10 |

### Accent

| | |
|---|---|
| HEX | #FF4A1C |
| RGB | 255 74 28 |
| CMYK | 0 71 89 0 |

## PROPORTION

PER LAYOUT, BY AREA



PAPER 60% · INK 22% · 8% · 7% · 3%

## CONTRAST PAIRS

WCAG 2.2

INK ON PAPER

17.4

AAA

PAPER ON INK

17.4

AAA

GRAY 600 ON PAPER

6.2

AA

WHITE ON ACCENT

3.3

LARGE TEXT ONLY

# Display



A Swiss neo-grotesk for headings and the name, with tight apertures and a tall x-height. Set it large and tight, and hand over to the text face below 20 px.

OVERUSED GROTESK — 300 – 600

Aa

RULES — 3

### Horizontal terminals

C, G, S and the numerals cut off flat on the horizontal, so a tight headline locks onto the grid lines.

### Large and tight

Tracking −3% from 32 px up, −1% below. Never smaller than 20 px.

### Semibold is the name

Headings are medium. Semibold is kept for the name, so it stays the heaviest thing on the sheet.

SCALE — SIZE / LINE HEIGHT

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| DISPLAY | Start from type | 72 / 72 |
| H1 | Start from type and grid | 48 / 56 |
| H2 | Start from type and grid, then add the rest | 32 / 40 |
| H3 | Start from type and grid, then add the logo and the rest | 20 / 24 |

TYPE TESTER — 56 PX · 500

## Hairlines, grids & a drop of color

SIZE — WEIGHT

WEIGHTS — 4

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| LIGHT | Start from type | 300 |
| REGULAR | Start from type | 400 |
| MEDIUM | Start from type | 500 |
| SEMIBOLD | Start from type | 600 |

# Text

HANKEN GROTESK · 300 – 600

A plain grotesk for everything you read, from the lede to the small print. Open counters and an even stroke, so it holds up on uncoated paper and nothing fills in at 14 px.

| HANKEN GROTESK | 300 – 600 |
|---|---|

Aa

a e g R 3 7 & ?

| SETTING | 16 / 24 · 60–75 CHARACTERS |
|---|---|

A manual is read the way a brochure was: at arm’s length, a sheet at a time, often printed. So the text face does the quiet work. It sets the lede and the body, the captions and the small print, and never competes with the headings above it. Lines run 60 to 75 characters, paragraphs are split by space rather than indents, and the rag stays ragged.

Small print sets at 14 / 24 in the second ink, for notes and for captions under a picture.

| SCALE | SIZE / LINE HEIGHT |
|---|---|
| LEDE | Start from type and grid, then add the logo, the icons and the pictures. 20 / 32 |
| BODY | Start from type and grid, then add the logo, the icons and the pictures when the client has them. 16 / 24 |
| SMALL | Start from type and grid, then add the logo, the icons and the pictures when the client has them. 14 / 24 |

| INK | PRINTED, NOT RENDERED |
|---|---|

## Ink gain

Every letter carries a trace of spread, as ink does on uncoated paper: a hair heavier than the font. The PDF stays clean, the press adds its own.

## Paper

The sheet carries a paper texture that scales with it: dark specks on the paper, light ones in the ink, which never quite covers the fibers.

| WEIGHTS | 4 |
|---|---|
| LIGHT | Start from type 300 |
| REGULAR | Start from type 400 |
| MEDIUM | Start from type 500 |
| SEMIBOLD | Start from type 600 |

# Mono



Azeret Mono for everything you measure: labels, values and code, like the lettering on a drawing. Courier Prime, set in italic like a typed note, for the one line on a sheet that should stand apart.

AZERET MONO — 300 – 400

Aa

i l m W O 1 { }

COURIER PRIME — 400 · ITALIC

*Aa*

*i l m W O 1 { }*

HIGHLIGHT — ONCE A SHEET

*Start from type.*

### A special face

One line, a quote or a note in the margin, the way a brochure set one line in a face of its own. Never running text, never figures.

LETTERING — 2 TEMPLATES · 1 SIZE

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| LABEL | START FROM TYPE AND GRID | 300 · 12 / 16 |
| VALUE | #FF4A1C · 1440 × 900 · 8 px | 300 · 12 / 24 |
| CODE | --accent: #ff4a1c; | 300 · 12 / 24 |

# Grid

8 PX UNIT

Twelve columns on desktop, four on phones. The ruler lines behind this page are the grid itself, so anything off it shows.

COLUMNS

12 × FLUID · 24 GAP · 48 MARGIN

| SPACING | × 8 PX |
|---|---|
| S-1 | 8 |
| S-2 | 16 |
| S-3 | 24 |
| S-5 | 40 |
| S-8 | 64 |
| S-12 | 96 |
| S-16 | 128 |

BREAKPOINTS — MIN WIDTH

| NAME | COLUMNS | GAP | WIDTH |
|---|---|---|---|
| Phone | 4 | 16 | 0 |
| Tablet | 12 | 16 | 720 |
| Desktop | 12 | 24 | 1024 |
| Wide | 12 | 24 | 1440 |

Past 1440 the content stops growing. The ruler lines keep going to the edge of the screen.

# Icons

WITHOUT ICON SET

Without an icon set, labels and numerals do the job. Mono capitals in a square cell, never a borrowed icon pack.

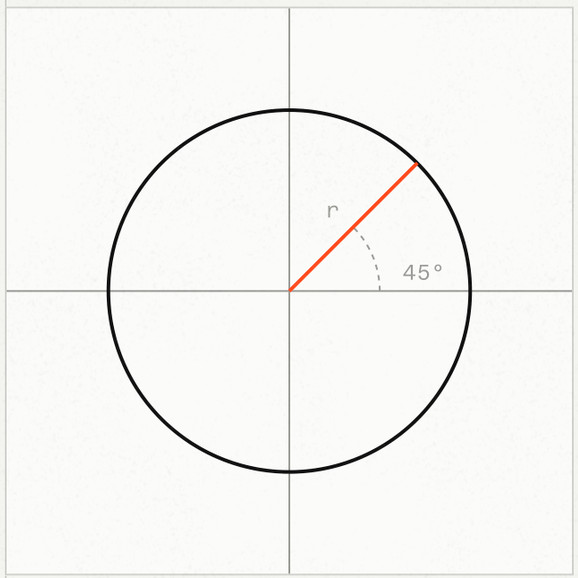
GLYPH CELLS

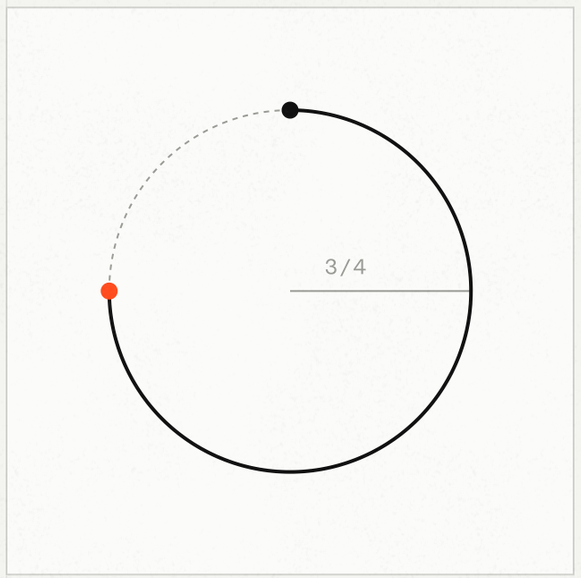
AZERET MONO 400

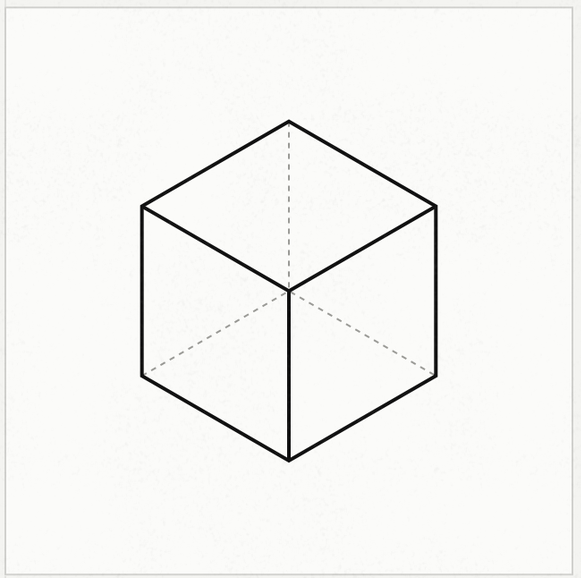
| → | ? | + | ≡ | ↓ | @ | 01 | × |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| ARROW | SEARCH | ADD | MENU | GET | MAIL | STEP | CLOSE |

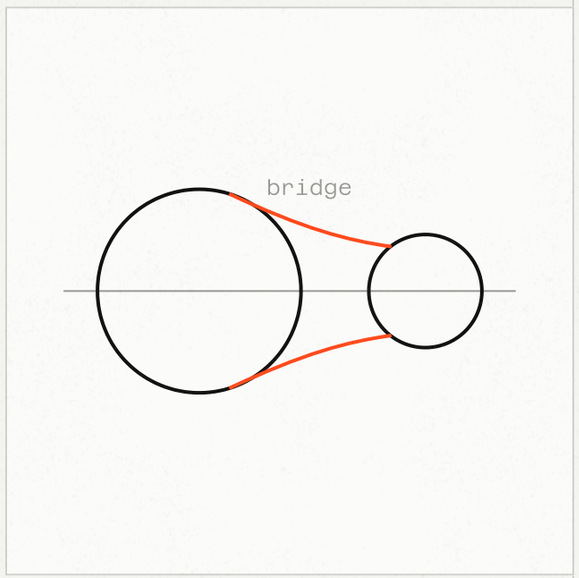
SKETCH SHAPES

ALWAYS AVAILABLE



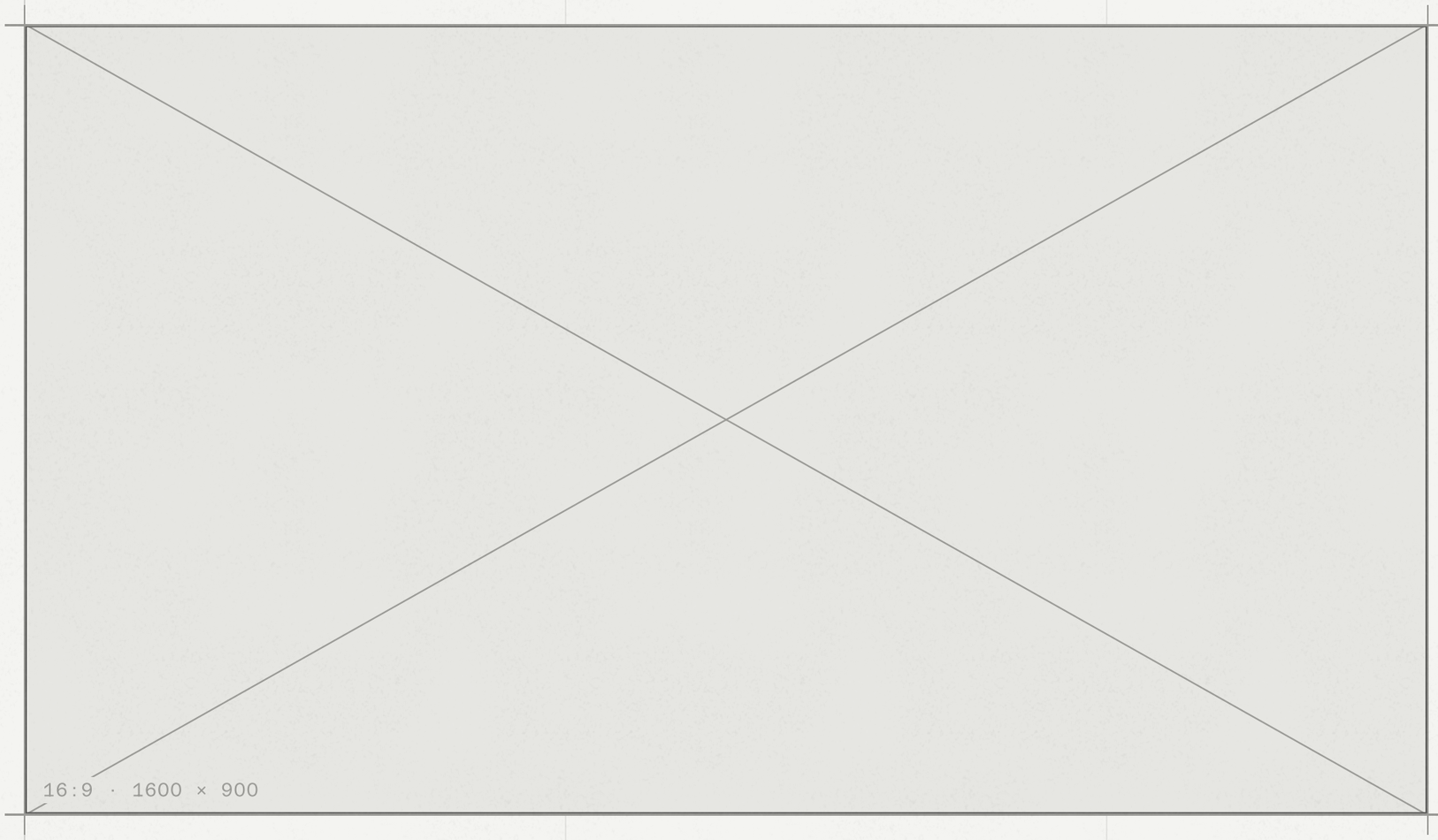



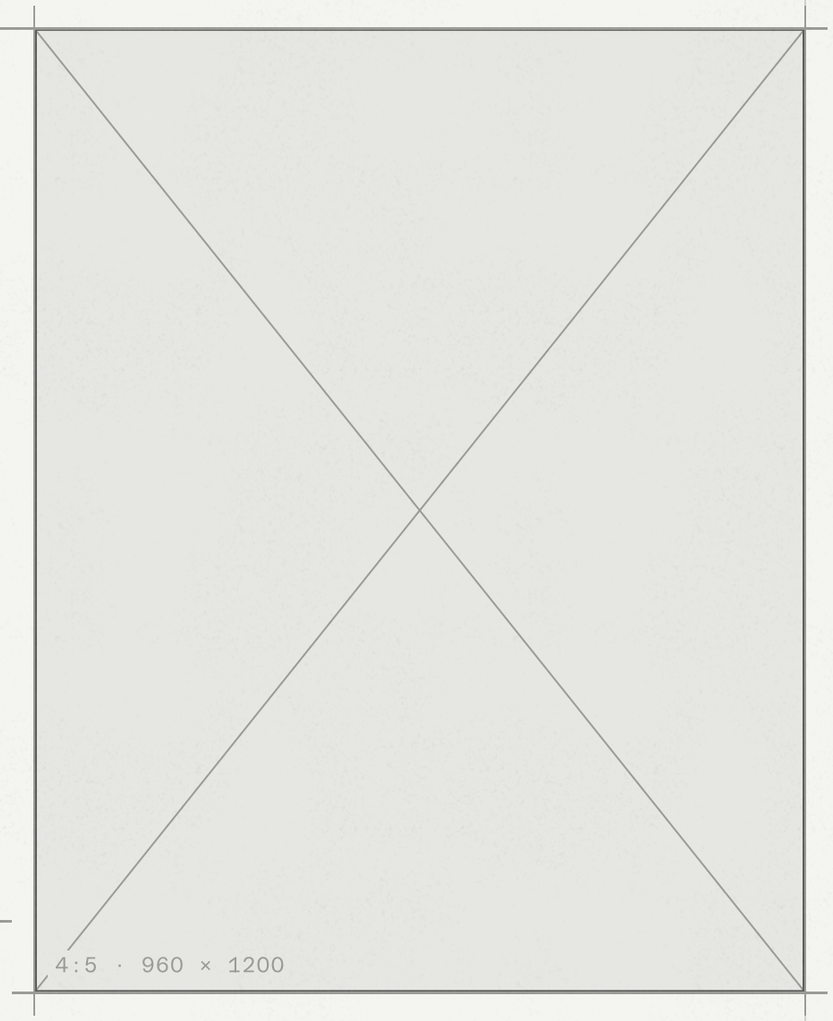


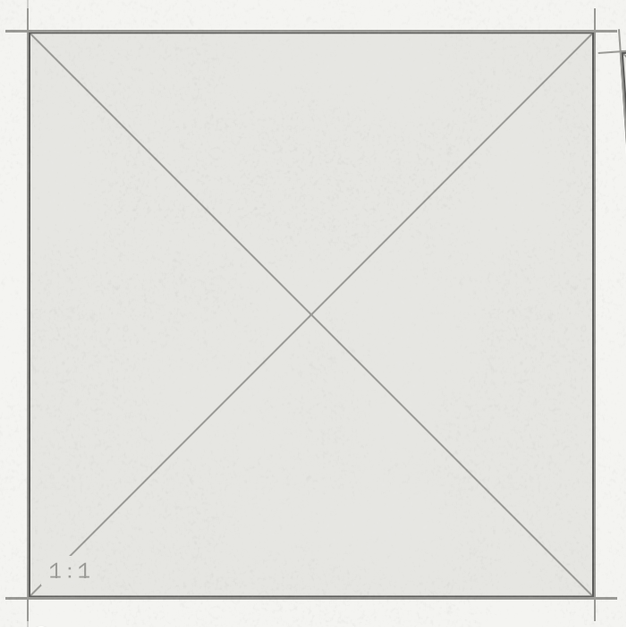
# Imagery



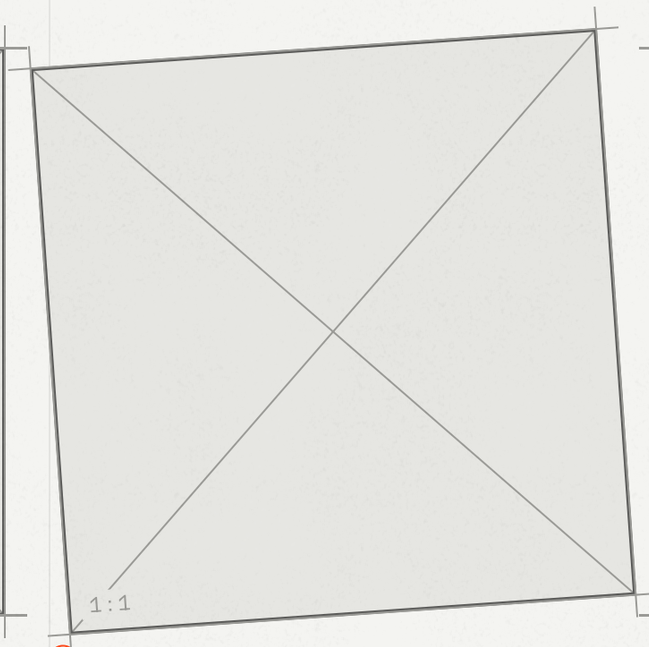
Until there are photos, every picture slot is a drafting frame: a light gray fill, crossed corner to corner, labeled with its ratio.



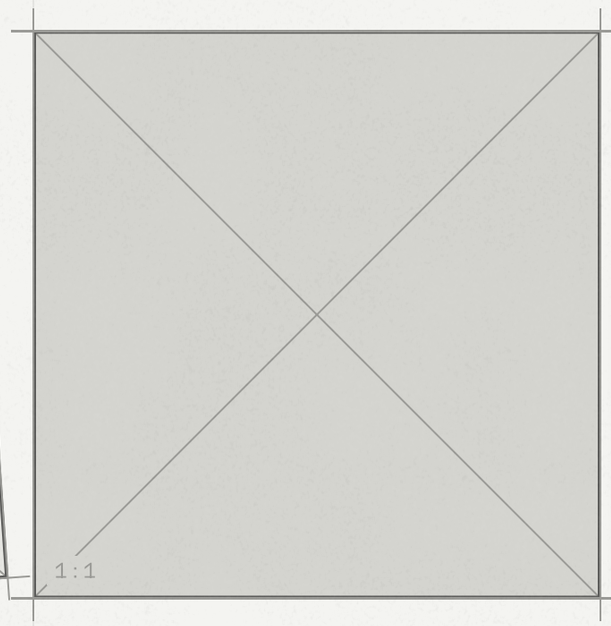



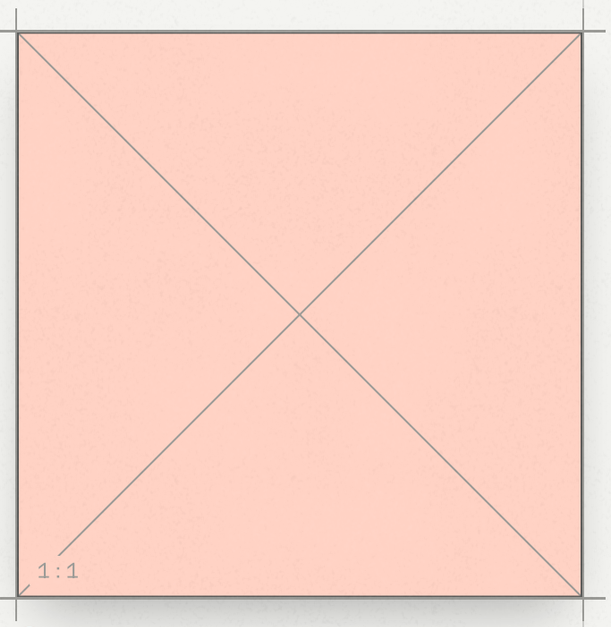

Crop on the grid




Don’t tilt or skew




Gray, one accent at most




No tints or drop shadows

# Components

Hairlines instead of boxes, solid blocks for actions, and the accent saved for the one thing the screen wants you to do.

## BUTTONS

48 / 32 PX

Primary Secondary Tertiary

Small Small Disabled

OVERVIEW ACTIVITY FILES SETTINGS

## CHIPS & CHECKS

24 PX

SELECTED WEB APPS PRINT

☑ Logo ☑ Icons ☐ Imagery

## FIELDS

UNDERLINE ONLY

NAME

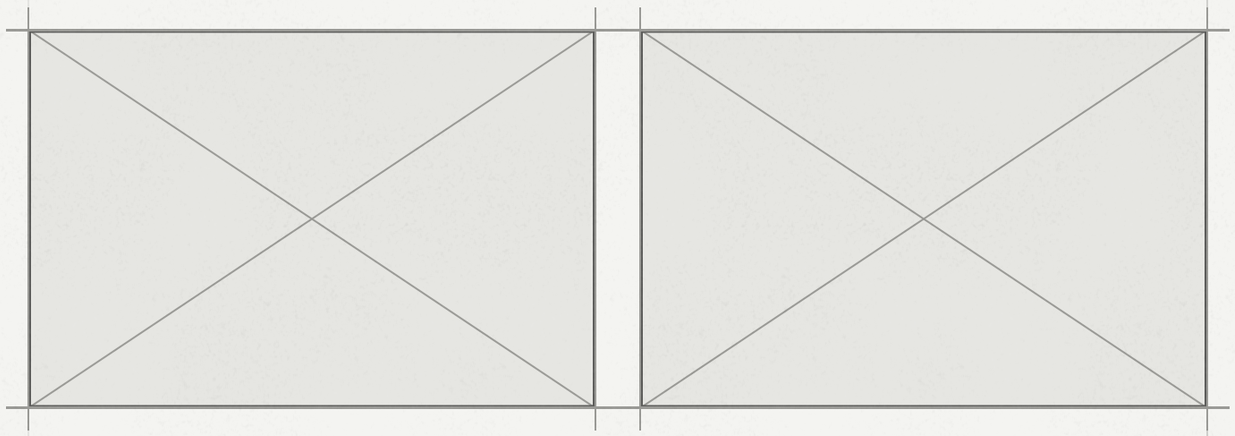
Your name

EMAIL · NEEDS AN @

hello.example.com

## CARDS

TOP RULE, NO BOX



### Case study

Short summary in two lines at most.

### Release notes

What changed and why it matters.

## TOKENS

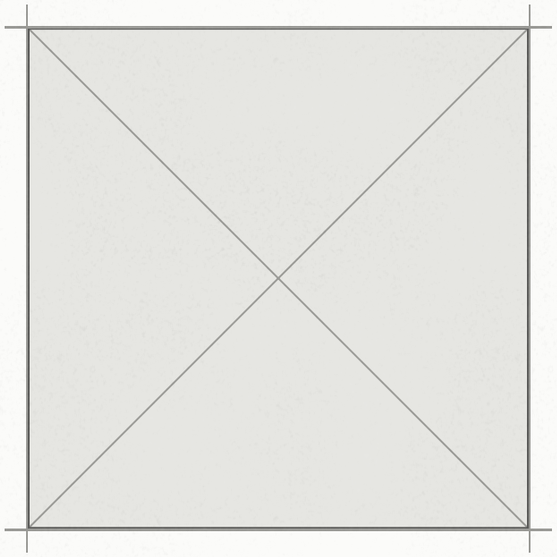
CSS/SYSTEM.CSS

| TOKEN | VALUE | USE | DARK |
|---|---|---|---|
| --paper | #F4F4F1 | Page background | #111110 |
| --ink | #111111 | Text, rules, primary fills | #EEEEEA |
| --ink-3 | #9A9A96 | Labels, annotations | #6B6B67 |
| --fill | #E6E6E2 | Drafting frames, skeletons | #222220 |
| --accent | #FF4A1C | One thing per screen | #FF4A1C |

# Apps

Four states every app needs before it needs anything else: the welcome, the empty list, the wait and the error.

01 · WELCOME

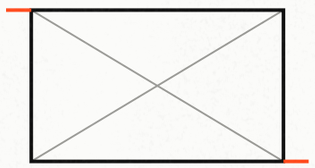


## Everything in one place

Your files, your tokens and your manual, always in sync.

Get started

02 · EMPTY



## Nothing here yet

Add your first project and it will show up on this page.

Add a project

03 · LOADING





04 · ERROR

ERROR · E-104

## We couldn’t reach the server

Check your connection and try again. Your changes are saved on this phone.

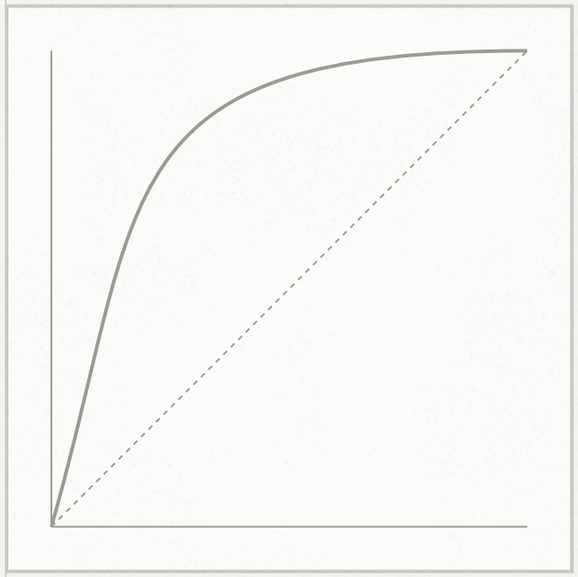
Try again

# Motion

CLICK TO PLAY

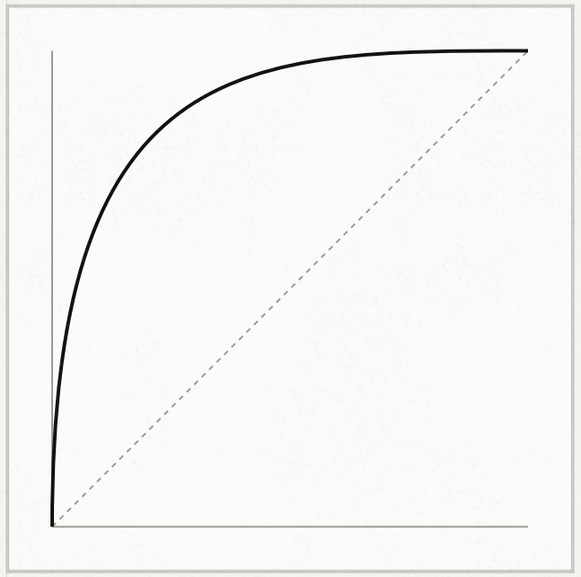
Things arrive fast and settle with a click, like a good switch. One curve for most of it, a detent for anything that toggles, and a spring for anything you drag.

STANDARD 240 MS



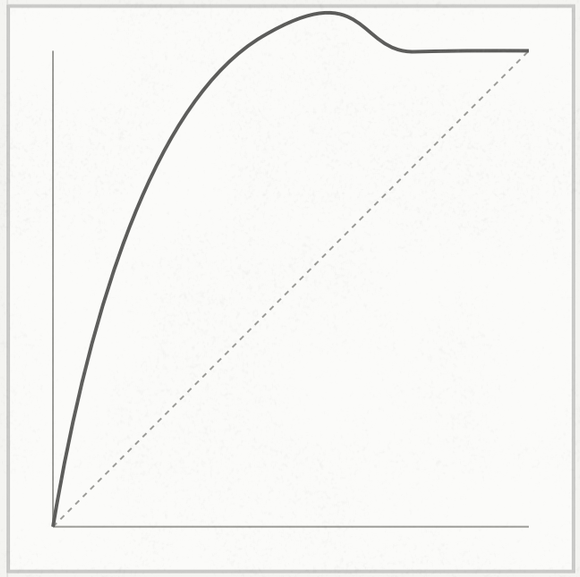
cubic-bezier(.2, .7, .1, 1)

ENTER 400 MS



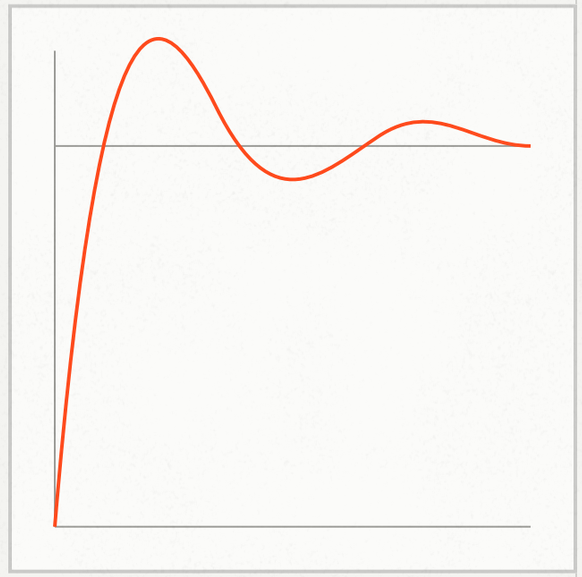
cubic-bezier(0, 0, .2, 1)

DETENT 320 MS



3% past the stop, then back

SPRING ≈ 560 MS



stiffness 320 · damping 22

# Voice

Write the way the page looks: short, plain, nothing that doesn’t carry weight. Say what happened and what to do next.

### Plain words

“Use”, not “leverage”. “Send”, not “submit”. If a word needs a tooltip, pick another one.

### Sentence case

Headings, buttons and labels all start with one capital. Mono labels are the only capitals.

### Verbs on buttons

A button says what it does: “Get the files”, never “OK” or “Click here”.

REWRITES

BEFORE → AFTER

BEFORE

~~Oops! Something went wrong. Please try again later.~~

AFTER

We couldn’t reach the server. Your changes are saved, so try again in a minute.

BEFORE

~~Unlock the power of seamless brand synergy today.~~

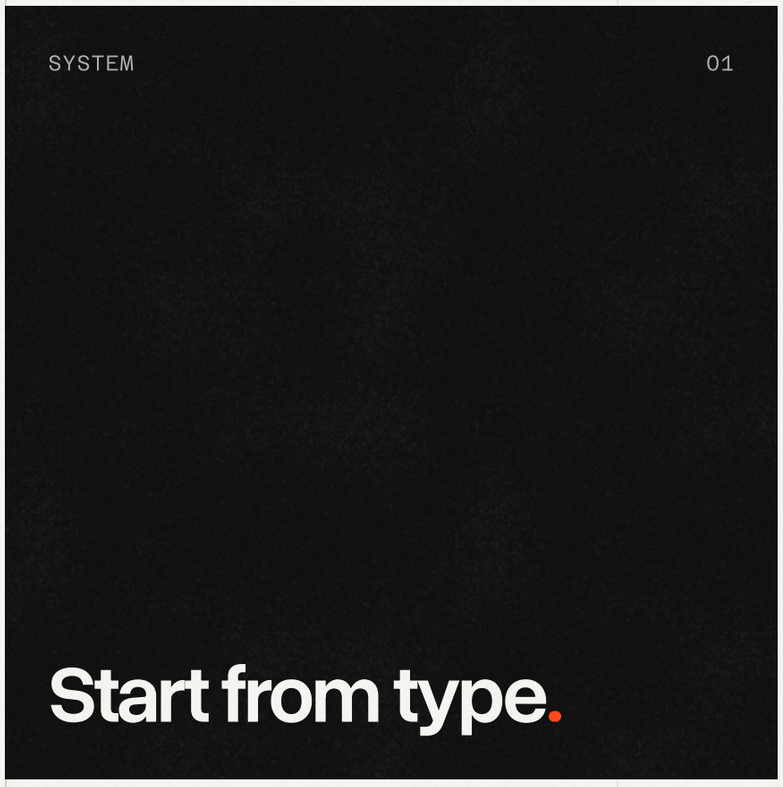
AFTER

Keep the website, the app and the posters looking like one brand.

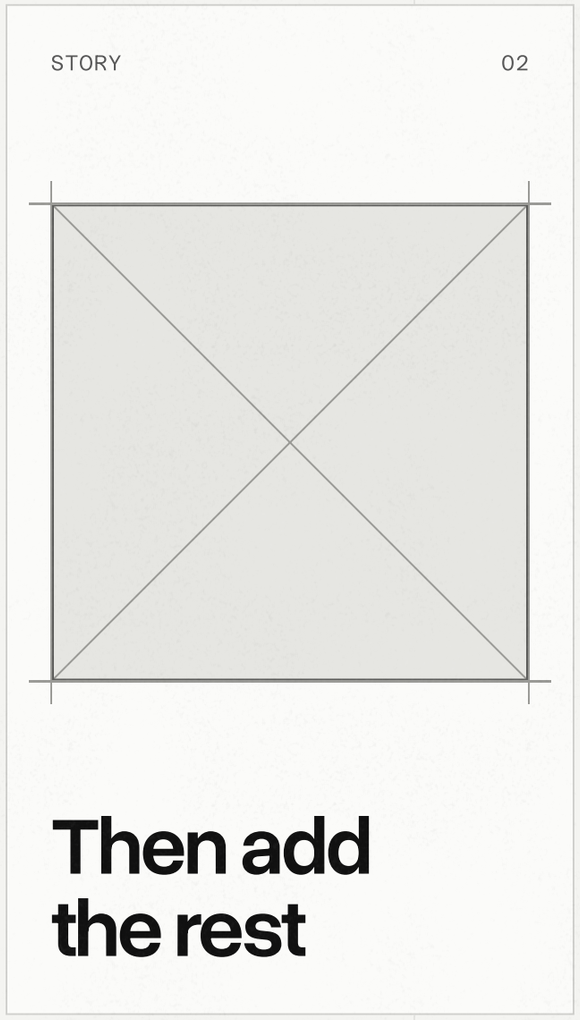
# Marketing



The cover idea at every size: one big line of type, a label in the corner, and the accent on one thing.




POST · 1:1 · 1080 × 1080




STORY · 9:16 · 1080 × 1920




LINK PREVIEW · 1.91:1 · 1200 × 630

## Build the brand once, use it everywhere

Get the files

LEADERBOARD · 728 × 90

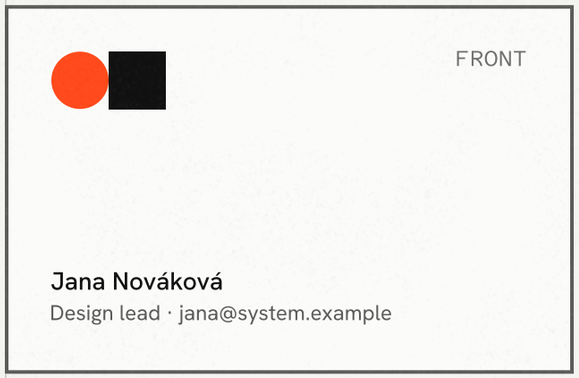
# Print

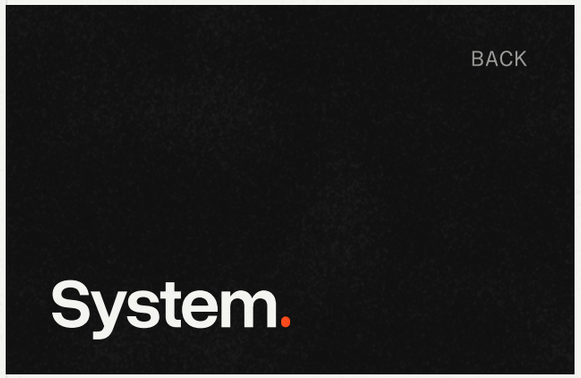


Cards and letterheads use the same grid, scaled to millimeters. Uncoated paper, one ink plus the accent.

## BUSINESS CARD

85 × 55 MM

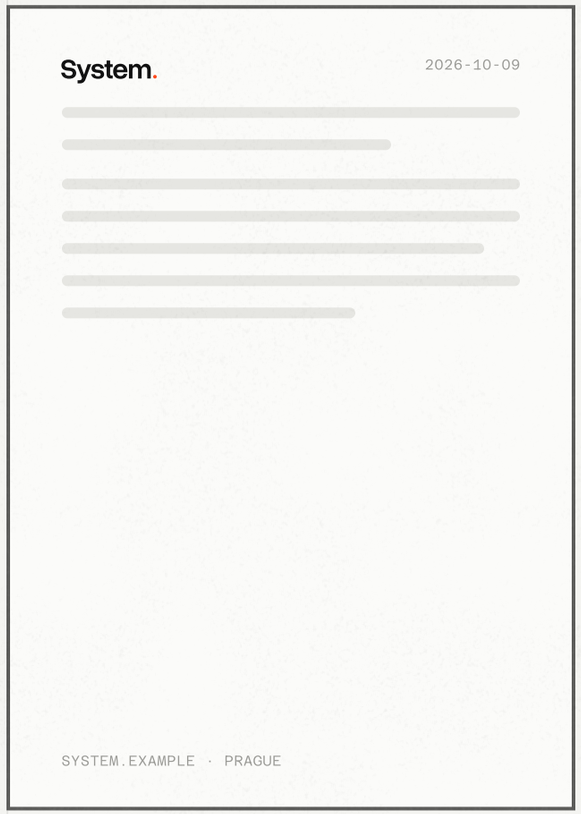


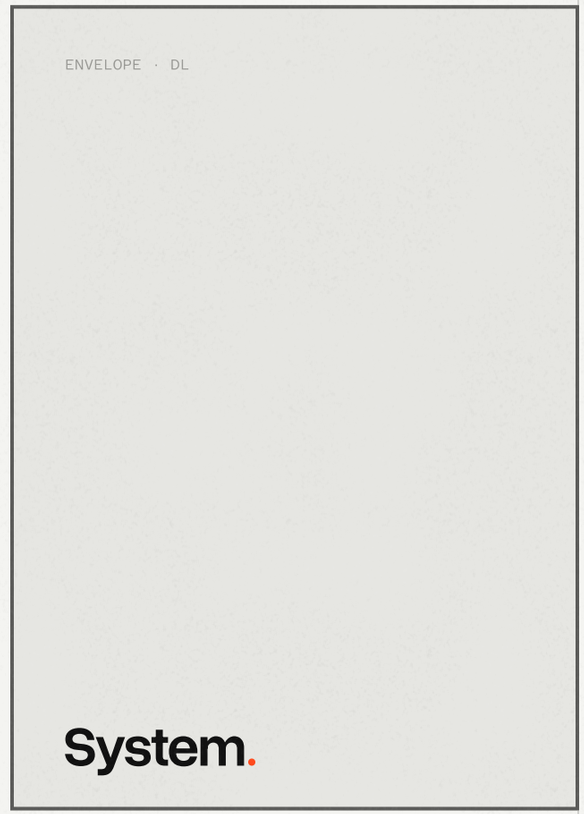




Front in ink on uncoated white, back flooded in ink. The name is the only line set larger than 12 pt.

## LETTERHEAD

A4 · 210 × 297 MM



# Downloads

Everything on these pages as files, built by one script. Hand over the link and you never send a logo by email again.

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Logo package**<br>SVG, PNG and PDF, every lockup, clear space built in | ZIP | 2.4 MB | Download |
| **Design tokens**<br>Color, type and spacing as CSS variables and JSON | CSS · JSON | 8 KB | Download |
| **Fonts**<br>Overused Grotesk, Hanken Grotesk, Azeret Mono and Courier Prime, all under the OFL | TTF · WOFF2 | 1.1 MB | Download |
| **This manual**<br>The whole manual as one file, fonts embedded | PDF · HTML | 8.5 MB | Download |

# Utility



The pages nobody designs. They get the same grid and the same voice, and they always offer a way back.

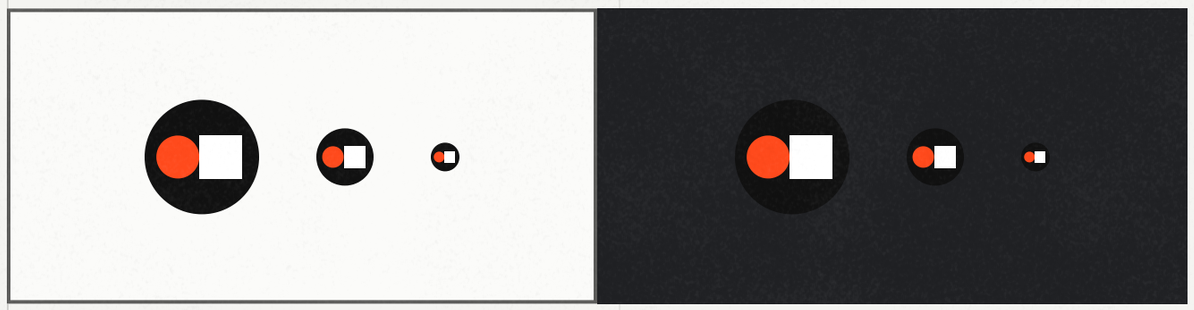
NOT FOUND — 404.HTML

# 404

This page moved or never existed. The cover is a good place to start again.

Back to the cover

FAVICON — FAVICON.SVG · 32 GRID



CHANGELOG — NEWEST FIRST

| | |
|---|---|
| 1.0 | First edition. Sheets 00 to 18, the with/without switches, light and dark, a PDF per language. |
| 0.2 | The sheets as artboards on one canvas, placeholders drawn like a drawing, Czech. |
| 0.1 | Tokens, the 8 px grid and the ruler lines. |

RULES — LIGHT AND DARK TABS

## The mark in a black disc

The circle in the accent, the brand’s dot, and the square in white, on a disc of ink. The disc carries it on light tab strips and dark ones alike, so the icon never follows the system theme.

## Optically centered

The mark is 12 units tall on the 32 grid and 24 wide, as large as the disc allows with an even margin, and sits 3% of its width left of center, like the mark alone anywhere else.